ROALLA



EXECUTIVE PSYCHOLOGICAL HEALTH AND SUSTAINABLE WORK GUIDE

Sustainable Performance Psychological Wellbeing and Work Life Balance

Manage workload attention boundaries and recovery through evidence based work design

Prepared for chief executives, boards, human resources, health and safety, operations, people leaders and employees

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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Purpose

This guide helps executives create healthier and more sustainable work without shifting responsibility for harmful working conditions onto employees. It combines recognized psychological health and safety guidance with practical workload, priority, boundary, recovery, breathing and mindfulness tools.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Sustainable performance depends on the design of work. Employee techniques can support attention and recovery, but they cannot repair chronic overload, unclear priorities, weak management, harassment or an always-on culture. Management should control psychosocial hazards first and offer individual practices as voluntary supports.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Can mindfulness fix excessive workload?	**NO**	Working conditions and capacity must be addressed before individual coping tools.
Should Kanban be used as a health intervention?	**NO**	Use it to expose demand, work in progress, blockers and trade-offs.
Is a disconnecting policy sufficient?	**NO**	Leaders must also change communication, coverage and consequence practices.
Should managers diagnose employees?	**NO**	Managers should observe work, listen, respond and connect people with qualified help.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A confidential psychosocial risk and sustainable-work assessment.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert concern into verified work evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material safety, privacy or professional-support issue overrides an attractive average.

Questions for Discussion

1. Which working conditions create the greatest sustained pressure today?
2. Where does committed demand exceed realistic capacity?
3. Can employees question priorities or deadlines safely?
4. What after-hours behaviour is rewarded in practice?
5. Which manager behaviours protect or undermine psychological safety?
6. How will confidentiality be protected in assessment and reporting?
7. Which organizational controls must precede employee training?
8. What evidence will show that work has become more sustainable?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Sustainable Performance Gates

These gates separate organizational responsibilities, manager practices and voluntary individual tools. A high score cannot override an unsafe workload, a material psychosocial hazard or a need for qualified professional support.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Leadership	Senior leaders own psychological health and safety	Policy, sponsorship, resources, consultation and visible behaviour
02	Demand	Work demand fits available capacity	Workload, pace, staffing, working time, interruptions and seasonal peaks
03	Clarity	Priorities and accountabilities are explicit	Objectives, roles, trade-offs, decision rights and escalation
04	Control	People have appropriate influence over their work	Autonomy, scheduling, methods, participation and flexibility
05	Support	Managers respond safely and consistently	Listening, recognition, accommodation, referral and conflict response
06	Boundaries	Recovery time is protected	After-hours expectations, coverage, vacation, notifications and emergencies
07	Skills	Practical tools are accessible and voluntary	Kanban, priority decisions, focus practices, mindfulness and breathing
08	Evidence	Improvement is measured without invading privacy	Anonymous input, leading indicators, outcomes, review and correction

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Psychosocial governance	Leadership, consultation, hazard management, policy and accountability	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Demand and capacity	Workload, staffing, working time, interruptions and priority stability	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Clarity and control	Roles, decisions, autonomy, participation and access to information	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Support and protection	Manager capability, civility, accommodations, reporting and referral	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Boundaries and recovery	Disconnection, vacation, coverage, sleep-supportive practices and personal time	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Measurement and learning	Confidential indicators, action tracking, outcomes and continuous improvement	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Leadership	Senior leaders own psychological health and safety	Policy, sponsorship, resources, consultation and visible behaviour
Demand	Work demand fits available capacity	Workload, pace, staffing, working time, interruptions and seasonal peaks
Clarity	Priorities and accountabilities are explicit	Objectives, roles, trade-offs, decision rights and escalation
Control	People have appropriate influence over their work	Autonomy, scheduling, methods, participation and flexibility
Support	Managers respond safely and consistently	Listening, recognition, accommodation, referral and conflict response
Boundaries	Recovery time is protected	After-hours expectations, coverage, vacation, notifications and emergencies
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ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Organizational Psychological Health and Safety Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	An executive sponsor is accountable for psychological health and safety outcomes.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Employees and representatives participate in identifying psychosocial hazards and practical controls.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Workload, pace, working time, staffing and priority change are reviewed as operating risks.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Roles, expected outcomes, decision rights and escalation paths are clear.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Harassment, incivility, discrimination and psychological protection are addressed through effective processes.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Managers receive training in listening, early response, confidentiality, referral and accommodation boundaries.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Employees can raise capacity or wellbeing concerns without retaliation or stigma.	☐	☐	_____
A08	A current disconnecting-from-work policy reflects actual communication and coverage practices.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Employee assistance, benefits, emergency and qualified professional resources are easy to find.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Health information remains private and reporting is aggregated appropriately.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Sustainable Work Design and Employee Support

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Teams compare committed demand with realistic capacity before accepting additional work.	☐	☐	_____
B02	A visible workflow identifies work in progress, blocked work, dependencies and waiting decisions.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Urgent work requires a stated consequence, accountable owner and explicit priority trade-off.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Focus time, breaks, vacation and recovery are protected through operational coverage.	☐	☐	_____
B05	After-hours messages do not create an unstated expectation of immediate response.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Meetings have a decision, collaboration or information purpose that justifies the time.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Mindfulness, breathing and recovery practices are voluntary, accessible and culturally respectful.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Individual tools are never used to excuse a hazardous workload or poor management practice.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Warning indicators trigger organizational review rather than employee blame.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Improvement actions have owners, dates, measures and a recurring leadership review.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Psychosocial governance	20%	Leadership, consultation, hazard management, policy and accountability	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Demand and capacity	20%	Workload, staffing, working time, interruptions and priority stability	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Clarity and control	15%	Roles, decisions, autonomy, participation and access to information	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Support and protection	15%	Manager capability, civility, accommodations, reporting and referral	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Boundaries and recovery	15%	Disconnection, vacation, coverage, sleep-supportive practices and personal time	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Measurement and learning	15%	Confidential indicators, action tracking, outcomes and continuous improvement	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Start with work conditions, governance and confidential evidence. Add manager and employee tools only as part of a broader operating response.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Establish	Confirm sponsorship, scope, safeguards and the current evidence for psychological health, workload and work-life balance.	Approved mandate and safeguards
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Gather anonymous input, review workload and work patterns, and identify psychosocial hazards.	Evidence and risk baseline
Days 36 to 55	Design	Define practical controls, manager practices, employee resources and measurement methods.	Target operating approach
Days 56 to 75	Pilot	Test changes with representative teams, protect confidentiality and collect feedback.	Validated pilot findings
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Approve owners, policies, training, measures, communication and review dates.	90-day implementation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish governance, assess psychosocial hazards and address immediate workload or protection concerns.
- Quarter 2: redesign priority, meeting, communication, capacity and escalation practices with representative teams.
- Quarters 3 and 4: expand manager capability, employee education, accommodation support and confidential measurement.
- Year 2: integrate psychological health and sustainable performance into planning, change, risk and leadership reviews.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA helps leaders translate psychological health and safety principles into work design, management practices, technology settings, policies and measurable operating change. Qualified legal, human resources, occupational health and clinical professionals remain responsible for advice within their scope.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Assess psychosocial governance, work design, workload, boundaries, leadership behaviour and evidence.
Work pattern analysis	Review demand, capacity, work in progress, meetings, interruptions and after-hours practices.
Policy alignment	Coordinate disconnecting, flexible work, accommodation, escalation, confidentiality and referral policies.
Manager enablement	Create practical conversations, workload reviews, decision rules and safe referral guidance.
Employee toolkit	Provide plain-language methods for priorities, focus, boundaries, recovery, mindfulness and breathing.
Technology configuration	Align notifications, collaboration tools, calendars and workflow systems with healthy operating norms.
Measurement framework	Define confidential leading and lagging indicators, baselines, ownership and review cadence.
Ongoing assurance	Monitor implementation, employee feedback, emerging risk and corrective action.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week sustainable performance and psychosocial risk diagnostic.
- Workload, meeting, communication, boundary and management-practice evidence map.
- Prioritized organizational controls with manager and employee toolkits.
- Executive readout and 90-day implementation roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Wellness substitution	Individual exercises conceal harmful work design.	Control workload, clarity, protection and support first.
Privacy harm	Sensitive information is exposed or used inappropriately.	Collect minimum data and report only protected aggregates.
Manager diagnosis	Leaders act beyond their competence.	Train for observation, conversation, accommodation and referral.
Performative policy	Written commitments do not change behaviour.	Measure operating practices and hold leaders accountable.
Survey without action	Employees disclose concerns but see no response.	Pre-commit governance, capacity and communication for action.
Priority theatre	Everything remains urgent despite new tools.	Require explicit trade-offs and capacity-based acceptance.
Boundary penalty	Employees face consequences for disconnecting.	Align expectations, coverage, performance and manager conduct.
Universal technique	One practice excludes or discomforts employees.	Offer choices and make participation voluntary.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

World Health Organization Guidelines on Mental Health at Work. Official source — Evidence-based recommendations covering organizational interventions, manager and worker training, individual interventions, accommodations and return to work.

WHO and ILO Mental Health at Work Policy Brief. Official source — A concise policy framework for preventing psychosocial risks, protecting and promoting mental health, and supporting workers with mental health conditions.

ILO The Psychosocial Working Environment Global Report 2026. Official source — Current international evidence on workload, role clarity, autonomy, working time, organizational justice and psychosocial risk prevention.

Mental Health Commission of Canada Workplace Standard. Official source — Canadian guidance and implementation resources for a documented, systematic approach to psychological health and safety.

Canadian Centre for Occupational Health and Safety Workplace Stress Guidance. Official source — Practical Canadian guidance on job demands, role clarity, control, support, recognition, workload and work-life balance.

Guarding Minds at Work. Official source — A free Canadian assessment and action resource covering psychosocial factors aligned with Canadian and international guidance.

NIOSH Total Worker Health Toolkits. Official source — Free organizational tools including the Worker Well-Being Questionnaire and a hierarchy that prioritizes work design before individual education.

Ontario Written Policy on Disconnecting from Work. Official source — Current Ontario guidance on the written policy requirement for covered employers and the scope of that requirement.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.